

OM AḶĀYA NAMAHA
OM AVYAYĀ NAMAHA
OM AVINĀSHINE NAMAHA
OM ACHINTYĀ NAMAHA
OM APRAMEYĀ NAMAHA
OM ADVITYĀ NAMAHA
OM ANIKETĀ NAMAHA
OM YATĀTMANE NAMAHA
OM ANTAH-SAKSHINE NAMAHA
OM ANTAR-YAMINE NAMAHA
OM ĀNANDĀYA NAMAHA
OM ĀTMA-SVARŪPĀ NAMAHA
OM MEDHAVINE NAMAHA
OM ĪSHVARĀYA NAMAHA
OM UḶĀRA-HṚDAYĀ NAMAHA
OM VĀGMINE NAMAHA
OM EKASMAI NAMAHA
OM OMKĀRAVIDE NAMAHA
OM KARUṆĀ-SĀGARĀYA NAMAHA
OM KARMA-PARĀYANĀYA NAMAHA
OM KĀLĀTĪTĀYA NAMAHA
OM VIBHAVE NAMAHA
OM KRĪTĀTMANE NAMAHA
OM KRĪTA-KṚTYĀ NAMAHA
OM SUHṚDE NAMAHA
OM GURĀVE NAMAHA
OM GUṆĀTĪTĀYA NAMAHA
OM GRANTHA-KṚTE NAMAHA
OM CHINMAYĀ NAMAHA
OM SHROTRĪYĀ NAMAHA
OM JAGAD-ĀTMANE NAMAHA
OM JAGAT-SAKSHINE NAMAHA
OM JANA-PRĪYĀ NAMAHA
OM JITENDRIYĀ NAMAHA
OM SANNYĀSINE NAMAHA
OM JĪVAN-MUKTĀYA NAMAHA
OM SUMANASE NAMAHA
OM SUHṚDE NAMAHA



CONTENTS

#CIRSCaptures - A curated collection of the many candid moments cherished by our student body.

The Editorial - A Giant Leap For Hinduism The Crossroads Editorial Team

Creative Corner - A creative deluge of student expression, showing the widespread creative potential of our students.

#CIRSCaptures - Stage decoration by Sri. Atul on the occasion of Hanuman Jayanti '25



08

**The Day The World Didn't End.
..(but Totally Felt Like It)**

Kum. Aashika

01
Libraries: A Story Worth Telling
The Editorial Team

02
The Magic Of Unboxing
Jashith

03
Photography
Ramkrishna Ajay Kulkarni

04
Modern Football
Mayank Damle

05
वक्तू
Amayra Goel

06
The Stance Of Unity
Aryaman Saraf

07
You're Reading This Because Of Him
The Editorial Team

09
Crossbusters
The Editorial Team

10
Screams Of Kashmir
Br. Sanatan Chaitanya

11
How To: Read Nutrition Labels
Krrish Anil Haran

12
Jallianwala Bagh
Ansh Chhajer

A GIANT LEAP FOR HINDUISM

Waves were literally made off the coast of Florida as Sunita Williams and Butch Wilmore splashed down after a slightly extended stay in space. Amidst the media frenzy at their arrival, what struck the people, especially the Hindus, was a picture transmitted back home from space by Sunita Williams of a Ganesha idol floating against a backdrop of the Earth. The very same Ganesha idol that she had carried carefully with her up to space, along with her prized Gita.

In an interview post-touchdown, Sunita said that those two things that she had carried up with her helped her sustain through her long sojourn in space - her Ganesha and her Gita. This is one of the many instances portraying the Hindu sentiment that has been gaining momentum for a while, with many people becoming more open about the Hindu changes in their lives.

Around the globe, celebrities have begun to share their experiences with the traditions of our religion, connecting to the teachings and crediting them for their various successes. We know the stories of Oppenheimer and Major Somnath Sharma, but do we know of Madonna and Will Smith, or of tennis pro Novak Djokovic?

Manu Bhaker, who literally made history as the only Indian woman shooter to become an Olympic medallist, has revealed that the teachings of the Gita inspired her during her heartbreaking exit from the Tokyo Olympics, and helped her recover and then focus through the finals of the following Paris Olympics. Among the stars of the Olympics, she stands out, not just as a medallist, but also as an open promoter of her culture.

While athletes have taken to Hinduism for its simple beauty and discipline, entertainers and public figures turn to this path for solutions to what they face in day to day life. One person from this endless list is Will Smith, who took to the Gita to escape the sticky and arduous problems that life throws as curveballs.

He discovered that one can never truly escape the situations that life presents by solving them continually, for life itself is a perpetual, perplexing situation. He immediately took to the concept of elevating oneself above such perplexing predicaments, and doing the sacred duty. He related to Arjuna's predicaments and understood the need for the Bhagavad Gita, which he praised in interviews that followed.

Not just the spiritual practices are being taken on by the West, but Yoga as well. A famous example for this is Madonna, who began practicing Hatha Yoga during her pregnancy, and later began Ashtanga Yoga as a replacement for the gym, and for mental and emotional clarity. She thinks of Yoga as a metaphor for life, and that one must take it slowly, breathe and let go.

Another household name that has been an admirer and promoter of Yoga is the 24-time Grand Slam Winner Novak Djokovic. He has incorporated yoga and meditation into his daily routine, and has talked about how it helps him physically, by improving breathing and flexibility, and mentally, through focus and emotional control. In the 2024 Australian Open, he even surprised the audience by showing off the flexibility that he credits to yoga.

Among these eminent, one-in-a-million performers, the only thing that is common is their open practice and praise of Hinduism. Even these western artists are turning to our practices for their simple yet profound ideas of life, and how to navigate its treacherous roads.



Hinduism is a way of life that connects the dots leading to higher living. Today, it is being practiced even by people who are not born into it, but have converted to it. When they can actively promote and practice Hinduism, reaping its benefits in their respective fields, why can't we? While these outstanding people have stepped out and praised OUR culture and religion, we, the people who live and breathe in the very place that it originates from, are the ones who are rejecting it. It is about time that we change, and bring about change. Being a Hindu and following its practices does not only raise one's standard of living, but is a way of continuing the rich legacy of the past into a brighter future. So stand out, and be an unapologetic Hindu, for it is a legacy to be proud of.



No TV? No internet? No Netflix? No problem! The Crossroads' got us covered with monthly issues filled with inspiring articles. Be it events of different clubs or student achievements, the Crossroads is a teeming hub that keeps everyone updated about what happens in this happening place. This 23rd edition, with its creative usage of Ghibli art, is truly a treat for the eyes.

- Dhruvik Agarwal, XII MGMT

- Naitik Agarwala, XI MGMT



Neuroplasticity is a fascinating, yet relatively lesser known, area of psychology that was explored thoroughly in your article ('Neuroplasticity', Issue 22). The amazing facts brought out such as Maguire's study and the immense potential of neuroplasticity to change oneself for the better, make for an educating read.

- Krisha Doshi, XII MGMT



- Harshidh Babu, XII SCI



For many of us in CIRS, books are a lifeline that we turn to at any time of the day (or night for some folks!). And catering to this demand are the Junior, Senior and IB Libraries of our school. To get the inside story on what makes these havens of fun and learning so popular, the Crossroads Editorial Team sat down with the librarians and students during one of the juice breaks. Excerpts.

Behind The Scenes: *WITH SMT. VAISHALI, SRI. SURESH & SMT. SATYADARSHINI*

How and why did you decide to become a librarian?

Smt. Satyadarshini : I had never planned to be one. I am actually an MSc IT and Psy, and worked as a programmer in HCL, Bangalore. After marriage, I switched to the education sector and became a librarian. Honestly, I find my current role more fulfilling as I can create better citizens for the country.

As children grow older, do you notice any changes in their reading habits?

Smt. Vaishali : After students transition from grade 8 to 9, they tend to prefer academic books over fiction books. Only about 20-30% of students opt to read novels. Sadly, library periods turn into time for completing homework.

Could you tell us 3 books that you would recommend for young readers today?

Sri. Suresh : 1984 (George Orwell), The Alchemist (Paulo Coelho) and Kane And Abel (Jeffrey Archer)

What is the best thing you like about being a librarian?

Smt. Satyadarshini : Being a role model to children. Surrounded by so many books, I am always on the lookout for how I can impact even a pinch of this knowledge.

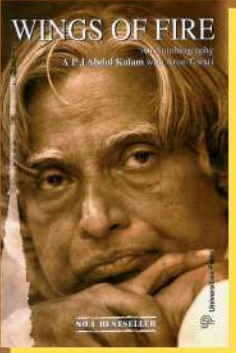


If a student asks you why he/ she should read books, what do you say?
Smt. Vaishali : I believe that everybody can and should read books. A reading habit increases creativity, knowledge, vocabulary, and critical thinking. Also, if we're facing any problem in our lives, books can divert our mind and help us relax.

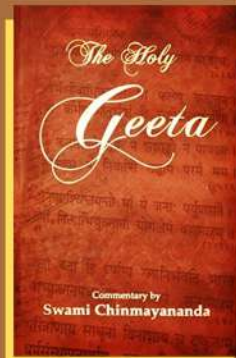


//The Librarian's Bookshelf//

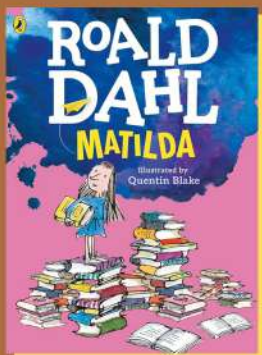
SRI. SURESH



SMT. VAISHALI



SMT. SATYADARSHINI



Which is the most issued book/ book series in CIRS?

Sri. Suresh : Harry Potter And The Philosopher's Stone.

Thank you for your time!



Why do you like coming to the library during juice breaks?

I always feel that instead of spending juice breaks chatting to people, it's better to come to the library and answer questions or simply read some comics. I usually do not see many girls there, but I always love to come.

- Nishitha Pokuri, VIII



When I come to the library I get the perfect opportunity to enter the world of imagination. During juice breaks, I especially like reading fiction books amongst the wide range of books available.

- Dhey Chapani, VII

Every day during juice break the library is the hotspot. Answering the trivia questions gives me the most satisfaction. And after that, just grabbing a book and reading makes life simple yet knowledge. It's a lot of fun.

- S. K. Gokul Adhith, VIII



THE MAGIC OF UNBOXING

There's something oddly satisfying about unboxing an Apple product. The unbelievably smooth way the cover slides off, the subtle hiss of the air escaping, the soft, velvety styrofoam layers and the best part - that first glimpse of your new device resting like a jewel in a treasure chest. It does not feel like opening a product that has been mass produced in the hundreds. Rather, it feels like unpacking a piece of art that has been designed just for you. This is no accident; it's the brainchild of the man behind Apple - Steve Jobs. And over the years, his packaging strategy has become synonymous with Apple's philosophy of perfection, attention to detail and commitment to leaving a lasting first impression.

But let's rewind the clock a little bit: years before Apple became a whooping 3 trillion dollar company, destiny had something truly unexpected for its cofounder Steve Jobs. He was removed from his own company in 1985. The same one that he had put his heart and head, sweat and soul into raising. But Jobs did not lose hope, he quickly moved on in search of something bigger, founding NeXT and acquiring Pixar in a span of just 2 years. Ultimately, life came full circle when Jobs was recalled to Apple in 1997. And he not only brought better products, but came with a philosophy that turned the sinking fortunes of the company around: EVERY MOMENT MATTERS .

This mantra was applied in a place most people wouldn't even dream of - packaging. Yes, the breathtaking packaging that envelopes every Apple product is the result of this very revolution. For Jobs believed that opening a product should feel as beautiful as using it. He said, "Packaging can be magic, it can be a story!" And that is exactly what Apple's packaging has nailed flawlessly. From the perfect fit of the box to the aesthetic layout inside, it's a premium experience that begins even before the device itself is even turned on. So much so that Jobs' decision to emphasize so much on packaging launched a global trend - unboxing.

And of course, where else did this amazing trend find space to grow then on social media and streaming giants? Soon millions of people flocked to Youtube to watch others open the same products they were planning to buy. Initially, Apple products' unboxings were the most prominent because they were JUST SO GOOD. Later, brands across the globe tried to copy Apple's unboxing magic. Some even came close to it, but none could match the same experience. For Jobs' unboxing was not just about creating a momentary feeling, it was about forging lasting connections with his customers.

It is unequivocal that Steve Jobs knew, and utilized, the immense power of presentation. An iconic example is the launch of the first iPad in 2010. Jobs started by announcing the price to be \$999. But then said that after asking his pundits he had decided to price it at \$500. This incident demonstrates the marketing strategy of 'Price Anchoring' wherein a higher price is initially quoted followed by a lower price to attract customers. The cherry on the cake was that after the announcement Apple's sales skyrocketed!

Even today, years after Steve Jobs has passed away his magic lives on in Apple's legacy of unboxing. Jobs didn't just revolutionize technology, he turned something as mundane as packaging into an extraordinary moment that you will never forget. He also understood what other companies didn't: people don't remember features, people remember feelings. And that's what Apple does best. Through their products they make you feel premium, they make you feel special.

Jashith | Grade IX, CIRS

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HOTOGRAPHY

THE CROSSROADS



They were talented, professional and cool. They were the real maestros of their profession, experts in the art of capturing moments using a metal and glass contraption. But most importantly they were ours. For. Two. Full. Unbelievable. Days. Those two days sped by in a flash of information and inspiration. We bombarded our mentors Amar ji, Gayatri ji and Bidisha ji, the resource people that had come from Chennai, with endless queries on how to get the perfect angle, position the perfect design and edit the perfect photograph. And surprisingly their ever patient answers dealt as much with philosophy as they did with photography. Looking back, our journey of growth over those two days can be summed up in just one word - perfection. It is just as Amar ji said, "Don't shoot for competitions, or to make money. Click to tell a story. Click to get the perfect shot in that moment. Click because you love photography." And we did.

MODERN FOOTBALL

MAYANK DAMLE | GRADE XI MGMT, CIRS



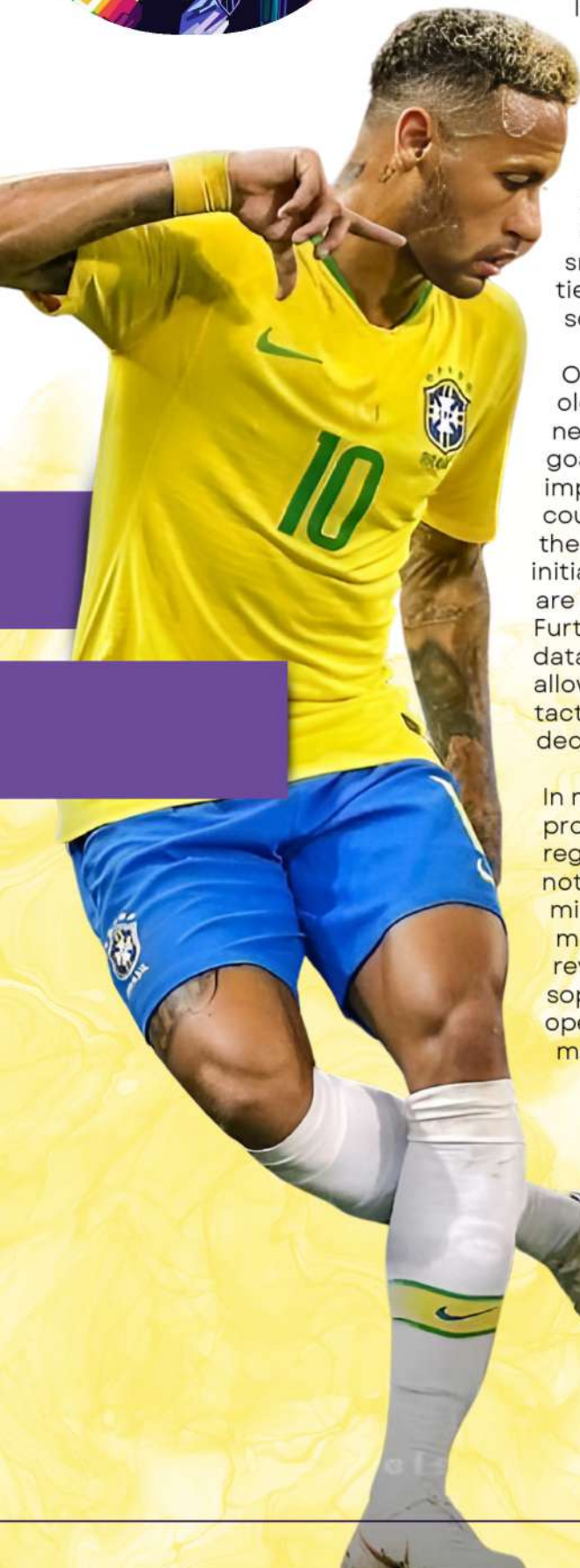
Football is a sport played between two teams with eleven players on each side. Whether it's the joy of victory, or simply the excitement of playing the game, football evokes intense emotions in fans and players alike. One of the reasons I love watching football is because of how thrilling every minute of it is. Rooting for your favorite team makes watching football special, and the bond you form with your teammates makes playing football equally special. In fact, football also plays a significant role in maintaining social cohesion amongst people and countries. Another one of my reasons is the community that surrounds football. It is an amazing feeling when you're standing in a stadium surrounded by thousands of fans cheering for their favourite team.

As football has become more popular, it has spread to various parts of the world, and has an effect on local people and their traditions. Football has also become more commercialized and is now seen as a profitable industry for many investors and businessmen. Unfortunately, this commercialization of football has also led to increased costs of tickets, merchandise, and expensive game time snacks, to name a few. This pursuit of profit over passion drives teams to tie up with sponsors such as betting companies, that put the integrity and social values of football in jeopardy.

Over the years, newer technologies have been introduced and many older rules have been modified for the present day. Some examples of new rules being introduced include the offside rule (19th century) and the goal line technology (2013). The VAR (Video Assistant Referee) was also implemented to reduce human errors in making crucial decisions that could impact the outcome of the match. However, it must be noted that the VAR's verdict is not final. It is up to the referee whether to uphold his initial decision or accept the computer's recommendation. These changes are being introduced to make the game more competitive and fair. Furthermore, companies are also creating "smart footballs", which provide data on speed, spin and trajectory of the ball. Modern technology even allows for a detailed analysis of player performance and development of tactical strategies that allow players and coaches to make informed decisions in real time.

In my opinion, these new rules and technological advancements have their pros and cons. While I do agree that the introduction and modification of regulations and practices have improved the game, it is also necessary to note how these changes impact the game itself. There have been cases of miscommunication between referees, leading to wrong decisions being made. The introduction of VAR has made players more likely to seek reviews after every minor incident, disrupting the flow of the game. Such sophisticated technologies are also expensive to manufacture and operate, making it difficult for lower league teams to keep up with the modern game. Furthermore, the over reliance on data analysis and computer simulations can overshadow the human element in making key decisions. Constant monitoring could also cause increased stress and anxiety for players.

I would also like to point out the role that social media plays in the modern game. Due to its massive global outreach, social media promotes football all around the world. It is a primary tool for players and teams to connect with their fans. Players can use social media to cultivate their personal brand, showcasing their personality and achievements on and off the field. For smaller clubs, social media networks also offer the opportunity to post clips of their games and attract an



international fanbase. On the other hand, social media can also be a source of extreme negativity. It can turn into a breeding ground for hateful comments that add further stress upon players who face online abuse after just one mistake. Moreover, expectations from fans online can cause further physical strain.

In conclusion, I can say with utmost certainty that football is likely to continue evolving, as new technologies and strategies continue to be implemented in the game. Unfortunately, many lower league teams continue to train and play with facilities that are just not good enough to raise the talent required for modern football. Therefore, addressing the financial disparities and ensuring fair competition will be crucial to the future of the sport. All we can do as fans is uphold the principles of the sport, and ensure that the game continues to grow fairly and is equally accessible to all strands of society around the world.



वक्त वक्त वक्त वक्त वक्त

AMAYRA GOEL | GRADE VIII, CIRS

हर घड़ी बदलती है,
रेत की तरह गिरती है |
वक्त को अपना ना समझो,
ये भी तुम्हे धोखा देती है |

वक्त का खौफ,
हर एक के रक्त में दौड़ता है |
वक्त का महत्व,
सबको न समझ में आता है |

बदलाव का आरंभ वक्त ने किया,
उसकी समाप्ति भी वक्त ने की |
न भागना तू डर कर उससे,
वरना वो भी भागेगी तुझसे |

वक्त गुमराहो को रस्ता दिखाती है,
अंजान चलने वालो को गुमराह करती है |
वक्त ने अगर तुझसे धो लिया हाथ,
तो कोई न बचा पाएगा तुझे हो दिन या रात |

वक्त एक पल का नहीं,
आखिरी सास तक का होता है |
एक बार जो चला जाए तो,
वापस लौट कर न आता है,
लौट कर न आता है |





The Stance of Unity

ARYAMAN SARAF | GRADE VIII, CIRS

Unity has been and always will be what has helped us survive and thrive in this world. From people coming together to form civilizations and settlements based on food and resources, to entire countries uniting to evict foreign oppressors from their lands. Unity has been essential in all these activities. It is just as the famous proverb rightly says, "Rome wasn't built in a day". I would like to add that Rome wasn't built by one person alone either. It was a team effort, as all great achievements are.

Moving forward let's understand what unity actually means. Simply put, the 'U' in unity is about your relation with others, how you feel about them. It's about you and me, it's about you and the world. Fundamentally, unity is about togetherness. It's about knowing your team's strengths and weaknesses, and working around them for the greater good.

In the world around us there are a number of places and situations where we can see unity at work. Let's take a quick look at some of them in this article. First, the freedom we enjoy as citizens of an independent nation. Most people understand freedom as doing whatever one wants to do. In fact, not to do what one feels like doing is true freedom. So, freedom is when an individual does not give in to the petty desires of his mind, and acts instead in the interest of the collective. In the same way, unity is fundamentally about the collective, not the individual. Unity means acting for the community not the people. Hence, unity leads to true freedom, which further leads to peace. Unity also needs to be there in an individual to achieve success in whatever actions one does. When a person thinks about something, they talk about it. What a person talks about, he ends up doing.

In essence, our thoughts and speech lead us to action. If either of these processes are disturbed it leads to failure and unhappiness. Hence, unity between these three are integral to efficiency in our work. Furthermore, unity is not something only meant for children's moral stories. It is extremely important for adults as well. To them it can mean unity at home by helping all family members. It can mean staying connected with old friends by getting in touch with them. It can even mean unity at the workspace by teaching colleagues new skills and uplifting the organisation as a whole.

In conclusion, unity must be gradually forged in all societies, communities, states, nations and finally the world. History is filled with glorious examples of people uniting to achieve great feats, it is the need of the hour to learn from these. Without unity we cannot achieve anything, but with unity there is nothing that we cannot achieve.



YOU'RE READING THIS BECAUSE OF HIM

For a long time, Bharat had been fraught with oppressive rule, foreign invasion, princely squabbles and internal strife. By 1916, the land was in continuous upheaval to free itself from the rule of the British. It was time for Providence to strike its hand!

The Stage Is Set

And strike it did. On May 8, 1916, near the serene Kerala backwaters, a child was born. He would become an erudite scholar, transformational teacher - and one of the most powerful orators of Truth who ever lived. The common man owes his spiritual awakening to this very Malayali baby born in the climax of India's freedom struggle. That boy was Kuttan and Parakutty Menon's son, Balakrishnan Menon.

Balan's first years passed with all the attention and affection possible, with five mothers to take care of his every need. Balan studied at Maharaja's College in Ernakulam where he was the leader of a cohort of boisterous, fun-loving boys. Growing up, Balan was a self-proclaimed atheist. Yet, when alone, he would secretly do his japa in his room. The spiritual Balan persisted, if only as a shadow, through to the day when he left home to enter Lucknow University in 1940.

Struggle and Strife

In 1942, at the peak of the 'Quit India' movement, Balan actively wrote and distributed leaflets to stir up national pride among the populace. Soon enough a warrant was issued for a certain Madras, Balakrishnan Menon. To evade arrest, Balan escaped to Kashmir and later Delhi. Two years later he resurfaced in Punjab only to be caught and promptly thrown into prison. In prison, Balan was subjected to severe torture and contracted typhus in the cramped, overcrowded cells. One night, fearful of rising inmate mortality rates, the British threw Balan out onto the streets to die.

Here again Providence became his saving grace: a Christian lady took him to her house and nursed him back to health. During the long months of recovery, Balan took up his pen as a correspondent for The National Herald. It was while writing articles on themes of social injustice and poverty, that Balan's skill as a powerful wielder of words was honed.

It was in 1947 that Balan read an article on the sadhus of the North. Desirous of exposing these holy men whom he believed were leeches on Indian society, Balan set out to Rishikesh on a surgical strike: get an inside story on the life and lies of the Himalayan sadhus.



The Renaissance Road

Balan confidently met Swami Sivananda - one of the foremost spiritual masters of the time - at the Divine Life Ashram. But he was in for a surprise when he found that Swami Sivananda was no hermit sitting in the retirement of meditation. Swami Sivananda was on his feet 7 days a week, 365 days a year, and Balan soon found himself drawn to this enlightened saint. He was so deeply moved that he decided to become a sannyasi himself, and was initiated into the holy order on 29th February, 1949. Balan plunged three times into the chilly waters of the Ganga, with each dip his past life washed away like the wisps of a faded dream, he emerged the epiphany of a man reborn. He emerged as Swami Chinmayananda Saraswati.

Recognising his disciples hunger for knowledge, Swami Sivananda sent Swami Chinmayananda to study the scriptures further under God's own ascetic - Swami Tapovanam. And thus began 8 years of rigorous study in Uttarkashi, one that truly transformed the novice initiate into a learned master. One day, Swami Chinmayananda was meditating beside the flowing Ganga when he had a flash of divine inspiration. It seemed that Mother Ganga herself instructed him: "Take the knowledge of Vedanta down to the plains!" Inspired by this vision, Swami Chinmayananda began his 'Gangotri Plan' on December 23, 1951. It was truly an ambitious project - a cultural renaissance of awakening Indians to India.

A Saint For All Seasons

The 1st Upanishad Jnana Yagna was held in Pune and was attended by 17 people. Swami ji's powerful voice rang out the eternal truths of life in a modern and witty style. By the final day of the lecture series, his audience numbered in the hundreds and even spilled over into the lanes surrounding the venue! Following this grand success, Swami ji organised more discourses in metropolitan cities across India. One by one, the so-called educated elite of Bangalore, Calcutta, Chennai and Delhi fell under the magical sway of this hermit from the Himalayas. It was then that Swami ji's eager disciples proposed the formation of the Chinmaya Mission - an organisation dedicated to fulfilling Swami ji's vision for Bharat's spiritual and national revival.

As the discourses continued, Swami ji realised that catering to the needs of adults would itself not be enough, he had to spread the subtle Truth of Vedanta amongst the children, the youth and even the aged. Thus, a complete set of programs were initiated to take care of everybody. Balvihar, CHYK, CORD, Devi group, Study classes and Vanaprastha group were all started to fulfill just this vision. With so many dedicated volunteers and life-transforming programs up and running, the Chinmaya Mission was soon accelerating towards the achievement of its motto: "Maximum happiness to maximum people for maximum time."

Life To Legacy

Gurudev Swami Chinmayananda attained mahasamadhi on 3rd August, 1993, more than three decades ago. But one thing remains certain: the Chinmaya phenomenon is here to stay. Certainly, after Swami Chinmayananda's mahasamadhi, his legacy has made his name far more famous and enduring than ever before. A most inspiring aspect of Gurudev's life is that he was born in ordinary circumstances. Who would have guessed that the boy who had once questioned God would become a revered master? That his life would be a saga of complete fulfillment, of a man who rose to the pinnacle of glory. Gurudev's legacy is explicit: He did it! And so can you.



THE DAY THE WORLD DIDN'T END ... (BUT TOTALLY FELT LIKE IT)

KUM. AASHIKA | FACULTY, CIRS

It was a Tuesday. Which already put Aarav in a bad mood. Tuesdays are like the forgotten middle child of the week—no beginning-of-week motivation, no weekend anticipation, just... oatmeal and disappointment.

But this Tuesday was worse. Aarav had just bombed his audition for the school band. Like, epic-YouTube-fail-level bombed. He played the wrong song. A whole different song. The judges looked at him like he'd performed a funeral march at a wedding.

So he did what any self-respecting teenager would do: He put on his hoodie, pulled the strings so tight he looked like a turtle retracting into its shell, and disappeared into the last bench of the library. That's where he met Meher. She was eating marshmallows out of a Ziploc bag like popcorn. Just casually, like that's a normal Tuesday thing. "You look like your soul got stepped on," she said, offering him one. Aarav declined. He didn't deserve marshmallows.

"What happened?" she asked.

He told her everything—the wrong song, the judge's eye twitch, the humiliation. Then she said something weird: "Can I teach you how to time travel?" Meher explained something called the mental time travel. "Your brain's basically a time traveler," she said, tapping her temple. "It replays old stuff and imagines the future. Like an overachieving Netflix binge." She told him to close his eyes and fast-forward his life five years.

"Imagine you're in college. You're not even thinking about this audition anymore. You have bigger, weirder problems now." Aarav reluctantly played along. He imagined a version of himself—cooler, taller, obviously—playing music at open mics, maybe laughing about this day with friends. And suddenly, the moment didn't feel so catastrophic anymore. Temporal distancing. One marshmallow later, he could breathe again.

That evening, Aarav sat on his bed, doom-scrolling reels with the emotional range of a potato chip. Then he remembered Meher's "Phase Two." But instead of telling him to do silly dares, she'd given him an actual list earlier that day:

Aarav was skeptical, but he picked three. He started with the music. Tamil lo-fi. Weirdly calming. Then he unfollowed a meme page that made fun of people like him... and followed a beatboxer who made music with everyday objects. Lastly, he opened WhatsApp and messaged the kid who sat behind him in chemistry. Aarav felt like his brain had just done yoga.

That night, he remembered Meher's final trick: Cognitive Reappraisal. Fancy term for flipping how you see something. So instead of telling himself "I'm a disaster," he reworded it: "That was hilarious. And brave. And now I'll always have a story better than 'I nailed my audition.'"

Pick three flips from this list and do them today. No skipping. No overthinking.

Flip your playlist – listen to music from a language or genre you never touch.

Flip your feed – unfollow 5 accounts that drain you, follow 5 that inspire or teach.

Flip your lens – take photos of the “boring” things around you and find the beauty.

Flip your convo – ask one person a deep question instead of “what’s up?”

Flip your evening – instead of screens, try an offline skill: sketch, cook or journal.



“REAL GROWTH
DOESN'T SHOUT.
IT ADAPTS.
SILENTLY.
SMARTLY.
POWERFULLY.”

Here's the thing no one puts in your textbook—but you should probably tattoo it on your brain: You've got a mental toolkit way more powerful than any app or shortcut. First, your brain is a time machine. Seriously. You can mentally fast-forward out of your current chaos, zoom out, and realize—this one moment isn't your whole story.

Next, you can flip the script. The music you hear, the content you consume, the conversations you choose? That's your daily programming. Change the input, change the vibe. Then comes the secret sauce—reframing. Every “I messed up” can be flipped into “I'm learning,” and suddenly you're not spiraling, you're evolving.

And finally, the most underrated flex: psychological flexibility. It means bending without breaking, flowing without faking, adjusting without losing yourself. That's not being weak—that's being a ninja in a mental hoodie. Real growth doesn't shout. It adapts. Silently. Smartly. Powerfully.

Mental Time Travel (Chronesthesia):

Our brains can simulate both the past and future. This “mental time machine” is part of what helps us reflect, grow, and prepare. When Aarav imagined his future self looking back at this day, he used temporal distancing, which reduces emotional intensity and increases resilience.

Novelty and the Flipbook Challenge:

Doing new things in familiar environments disrupts mental autopilot. It lights up reward circuits and boosts neuroplasticity. That's why the “flip your feed / playlist / convo” idea works so powerfully, especially for teens in routine-heavy lives.

Cognitive Reappraisal:

Reframing a failure as a learning moment or even a funny story activates your prefrontal cortex (logic and control center), which calms your amygdala (the panic center). This isn't just “thinking positive” – it's science-backed emotion regulation.

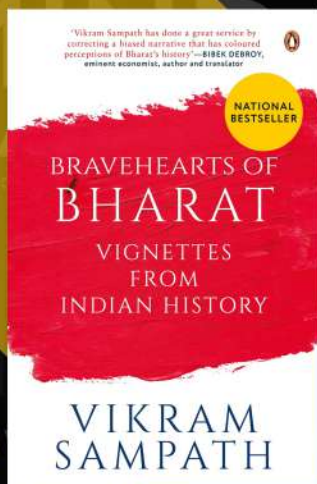
Psychological Flexibility:

This is the real superhero skill: being able to hold discomfort, reflect, and still choose values-based action. Aarav didn't erase the failure – he accepted it, shifted his perspective, and created something meaningful from it.

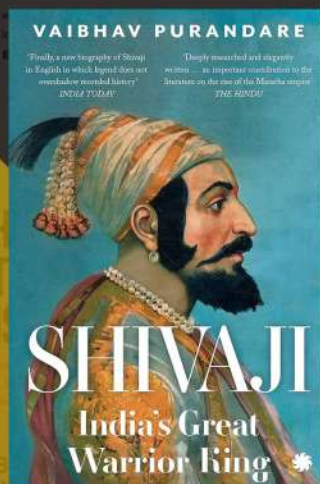


CROSSBUSTERS

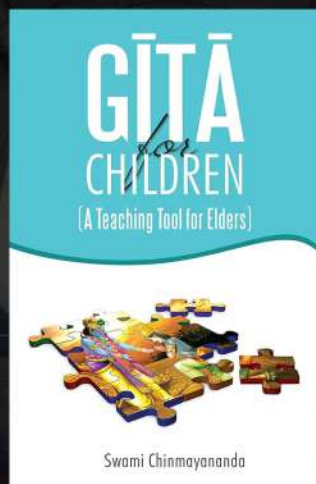
Attention all book lovers and movie buffs! Are you often confused as to which book to pick at the library? Or spoilt for choice on Netflix? But never fear for your friendly neighbourhood Crossroads Team is here with a selection of books and movies that will inspire, educate and entertain you throughout your summer vacations. Happy reading and watching!



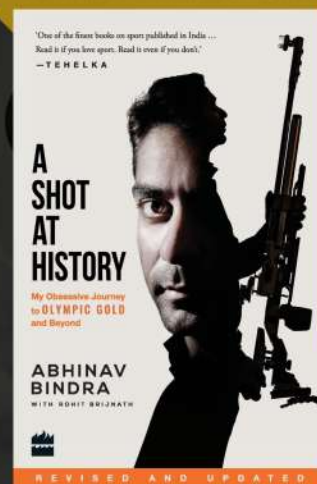
Fifteen brave men and women of Bharat who made unimaginable sacrifices for their motherland. Reading this is life changing.



A fresh, much needed account of the inspiring life and feats of the king and visionary behind the Maratha empire.



Detailed summaries of each chapter, important verses highlighted and doubts cleared. Read this to find your ultimate mentor in Lord Krishna.



An athlete's journey as he goes after his obsession to achieve the highest glory and standard his sport can offer.



This film dives deep into the life of the legendary emperor who defied the Mughals to keep the flame of Swaraj burning bright. Guaranteed to bring tears to your eyes.



A driven young man joins the US Army during WWII on an unusual condition: he won't hold a gun or fire a shot. He turns out to be the one of the greatest heroes of the war.



At times serious, reflective and downright funny, this one's about the three African-American mathematicians who dealt with racial and gender discrimination at work.



A talented baseball player is drafted to play in the Major League. His only crime? He's African. Watch to find out how he fights against racism to continue playing the sport he lives for.

SCREAMS OF KASHMIR

BR. SANATAN CHAITANYA

Blood stains the meadows, Hindu hearts torn apart,
In Kashmir's embrace, hate's venomous dart.
They died for their faith, yet the world turns away,
Silenced by trends, where no hashtags sway.
My voice cracks, raw, screaming into the void,
Hindus, my kin, by denial destroyed.
Hinduphobia festers, ignored, unaddressed,
We shrug, we forget, leaving truth suppressed.
Why do we cower, blind to our pain?
Our brothers' cries drowned in apathy's chain.
I rage, I weep, but minds stay unmoved,
Complicity cloaks the justice we've proved.
Their names erased, their stories untold,
By media's whims, by narratives cold.
Our temples burn, our roots torn asunder,
Yet we stay mute, lost in our slumber.
No clamor rises, no fists pound the sky,
While martyrs' blood begs for a battle cry.
Our silence betrays the gods we revere,
Feeding the hate that thrives on our fear.
Rise, oh my people, shatter this trance,
For Kashmir's fallen, we must take a stance.
Their fight is ours, in their blood we're bound,
Speak, roar, awaken — let Hindu truth resound.



MASSACRE
PORA KILLING
SHIMIR
ALDOSA MASSACRE
DARIBAL CASE
TANGUDAR

KUPWARA
CRESPORA
BIJBEHARA
DO

MURDER
TR
RTBAITENC
CRESPORA
KILLING B

SHOPIAN KILLING
ZAKURA MASSACRE
KUPWARA MAS
KISHIWAR MASSACRE
SANGRAMPORA
SHOPIAN RAPE CASE
BIJBEHARA MAS



NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION (APPROX.)		
	Actual	Per 100g
Energy	247	247
Protein	0	0.9
Total Carb. (Hydrate)	0	47.6
of which Sugars	0	4.1
Total Fat	0	14.1
Saturated Fat	0	0.1
Salt	0	0.2



How To: READ NUTRITION LABELS

KRRISH HARAN | IB II YEAR, CIRS

Let's be honest –we've all had those late-night cravings or post-exam snacks where a pack of chips, a

bar of chocolate, or a scoop of ice cream magically solves our life problems. But here's the thing: if food had a "behind the scenes" documentary, these snacks would be villains dressed up as heroes. And today we're exposing them.

Most of us never bother to check what's written on the back of the packet—we just see the shiny cover, trust it, and start eating. But that tiny label? It hides the truth that companies don't want us to notice. Even though we know the truth, we still ignore reality.



Let's start with the classic snack trap—Blue Lay's.

The ingredients? Potatoes, edible vegetable oil, and salt. Looks simple. But here's what most people don't know: ingredients are listed in order of quantity. So what's first is what you're eating the most of. While potato comes first, now comes the real issue: how it's made. Those thin slices are deep-fried in oil until they soak it up. And let's not forget the overloaded salt. And you know what's worse? When you open a packet, you'll find only about 30% chips and 70% air. Yup—you're paying for air inside a pack. Do you think it's a light snack? Nah, it's deep-fried with air inside.

Now, let's unwrap the sweet trap—Dairy Milk. With "milk" in the name, you'd assume milk is the star. But nope—the first ingredient is sugar. In a 100g bar, there are around 12 teaspoons of it; that's around 59 grams of sugar in it! That's like someone handing you a cup of sugar and saying, "Enjoy your dessert!" The rest of the bar is filled with milk solids, emulsifiers, and chemicals that make you feel satisfied while your body silently screams. You may think it's comfort food, but it's not.



And do you know the bigger picture? It's all a strategy. Companies use this deadly trio—salt, sugar, and fat—to trigger cravings, and we fall into the trap. It's not food; it's a trap designed to make us fall into it and be repeat customers. And while they cash in on our cravings, you deal with tiredness, breakouts, weight gain, and even early health problems.



Indulging in such packaged poison isn't a cheat day. It's a scam. And you're the one being cheated.

So what now? It's simple: flip the pack, read the label, and decode the lies.

So the next time someone hands you a chocolate or a bag of chips, just remember—you're not consuming a snack. You're ingesting extra fat, hidden salt, cholesterol and sugar. So just smile and say, "No thanks!" Because real strength isn't in controlling your cravings—it's in seeing the scam and choosing not to play along and fall into the trap.

Your body isn't a dustbin.

So, stop feeding it garbage with a fancy name. Real food doesn't lie. Real food doesn't hide. Real food doesn't need to be sold with slogans.

JALLIANWALA BAGH

ANSH CHHAJER | GRADE IX, CIRS

A day of celebration gone wrong,
Hundreds killed amongst the peaceful throng.
As parents weep and children mourn,
Jallianwala Bagh, once cheerful, was left forlorn.

A merciless killing that none escaped,
The dead and the dying, a gruesome landscape.
Of the massacre the English were proud,
But little did they know it was their own shroud.

Flames of resilience and vengeance were stoked,
It was only a short while before the British broke.
As courageous heroes rose hand in hand,
Forcing the British to leave our land.

Bharat remembers, Bharat relives,
She will never forget, she will never forgive.
Her children remember, her children relive,
We will never forget, we will never forgive.

Captures

@CIRS







CREATIVE CORNER



Govardhan. ~ VI 🎨



Ekaklavya A. ~ VIII 🎨



Radha G. ~ XI 📷



Aaryaman S. ~ VIII 🎨



Dhriti Savani - IB 2 📷



Naitik A. ~ XI 



Vivaan R. ~ IX, Nehaa S. K. ~ X 



Prahalad S. ~ XI



Yuvika A. ~ VIII 



Aradhya E. S. ~ VIII 



Saachi K. ~ X 



Raam Bodhidharaman. ~ V 

A little ambition is good, but this young man wants to carry the whole Himalaya! But one thing that I can say about Chinmaya is that he is fearless. . .when you have one quality totally developed, all others come to you. . .when that quality is dedicated to a higher ideal, then the whole universe comes to aid you.

May 2025 | Harnessing Youth Potential Through Dynamic Spirituality

I am a #ProudPractisingHindu

